REGIONAL DEVELOPMENT AND FIVE YEAR PLANS

DIVERSITY VERSUS DISPARITY → UNEVEN DEVELOPMENT DRIVERS → GROWTH POLE MECHANISM → CORE-PERIPHERY AND BACKWASH → PLANNING REGION CRITERIA → INDIAN PLANNING TIMELINE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◆ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artifacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g4 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 DIVERSITY VERSUS DISPARITY

DIVERSITY VERSUS DISPARITY · DIFFERENCE OF CHARACTER · LANGUAGE, ECOLOGY, CULTURE, CROPS · RANKED INEQUALITY · INCOME, LITERACY, HEALTH, INFRASTRUCTURE · DIVERSITY IS ACCOMMODATED; DISPARITY IS REDUCED · TREATING INEQUALITY AS HARMLESS VARIETY IS A DIRECT EXAM

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS	TRIGGER / MECHANISM	EFFECT / INTERVENTION
DIVERSITY → difference of character: language, ecology, culture, crops	POLICY → diversity is accommodated; disparity is reduced	DIVERSITY → difference of character: language, ecology, culture, crops
DISPARITY → ranked inequality: income, literacy, health, infrastructure	TRAP → treating inequality as harmless variety is a direct exam error	DISPARITY → ranked inequality: income, literacy, health, infrastructure

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS
- DIVERSITY → difference of character: language, ecology, culture, crops
- DISPARITY → ranked inequality: income, literacy, health, infrastructure

TRIGGER / MECHANISM
- POLICY → diversity is accommodated; disparity is reduced
- TRAP → treating inequality as harmless variety is a direct exam error

EFFECT / INTERVENTION
- DIVERSITY → difference of character: language, ecology, culture, crops
- DISPARITY → ranked inequality: income, literacy, health, infrastructure

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → treating inequality as harmless variety is a direct exam error.

01

STAGE 01 UNEVEN DEVELOPMENT DRIVERS

UNEVEN DEVELOPMENT DRIVERS · RESOURCE ENDOWMENT · MINERALS, FERTILE LAND, PORTS OR IRRIGATION CLUSTER GROWTH · TRANSPORT + MARKET · CORRIDORS AND URBAN NODES OUTPACE INTERIORS · HISTORICAL HEAD START · EARLIER CENTRES KEEP CUMULATIVE ADVANTAGE · STATE CAPACITY

RESOURCE ENDOWMENT → minerals, fertile land, ports or irrigation cluster growth → TRANSPORT + MARKET → corridors and urban nodes outpace interiors → HISTORICAL HEAD START → earlier centres keep cumulative advantage → STATE CAPACITY → policy and governance decide whether lagging regions catch up

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS
- RESOURCE ENDOWMENT → minerals, fertile land, ports or irrigation cluster growth
- TRANSPORT + MARKET → corridors and urban nodes outpace interiors

TRIGGER / MECHANISM
- HISTORICAL HEAD START → earlier centres keep cumulative advantage
- STATE CAPACITY → policy and governance decide whether lagging regions catch up

EFFECT / INTERVENTION
- RESOURCE ENDOWMENT → minerals, fertile land, ports or irrigation cluster growth
- TRANSPORT + MARKET → corridors and urban nodes outpace interiors

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: STATE CAPACITY → policy and governance decide whether lagging regions catch up.

02

STAGE 02 GROWTH POLE MECHANISM

GROWTH POLE MECHANISM · PROPULSIVE NODE · DYNAMIC INDUSTRY OR CITY BECOMES THE GROWTH POLE · SUPPLIERS, LABOUR AND MARKETS CLUSTER AROUND THE POLE · SPREAD EFFECT · BENEFITS DIFFUSE OUTWARD IF LINKAGES DEEPEN LOCALLY · A POLE MAY REMAIN AN ENCLAVE WITHOUT REGIONAL DIFFUSION

PROPULSIVE NODE → dynamic industry or city becomes the growth pole → LINKAGES → suppliers, labour and markets cluster around the pole → SPREAD EFFECT → benefits diffuse outward if linkages deepen locally → LIMIT → a pole may remain an enclave without regional diffusion

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS
- PROPULSIVE NODE → dynamic industry or city becomes the growth pole
- LINKAGES → suppliers, labour and markets cluster around the pole

TRIGGER / MECHANISM
- SPREAD EFFECT → benefits diffuse outward if linkages deepen locally
- LIMIT → a pole may remain an enclave without regional diffusion

EFFECT / INTERVENTION
- PROPULSIVE NODE → dynamic industry or city becomes the growth pole
- LINKAGES → suppliers, labour and markets cluster around the pole

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → a pole may remain an enclave without regional diffusion.

03

STAGE 03 CORE-PERIPHERY AND BACKWASH

CORE-PERIPHERY AND BACKWASH · CAPITAL, SERVICES, INFRASTRUCTURE AND DECISION POWER CONCENTRATE · LABOUR, RAW MATERIALS AND DEMAND ARE ORGANISED AROUND THE · TALENT AND CAPITAL DRAIN OUTWARD TOWARD THE CORE · TECHNOLOGY AND DEMAND MAY DIFFUSE, BUT NOT AUTOMATICALLY

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS	TRIGGER / MECHANISM	EFFECT / INTERVENTION
CORE → capital, services, infrastructure and decision power concentrate	BACKWASH → talent and capital drain outward toward the core	CORE → capital, services, infrastructure and decision power concentrate
PERIPHERY → labour, raw materials and demand are organised around the core	SPREAD → technology and demand may diffuse, but not automatically	PERIPHERY → labour, raw materials and demand are organised around the core

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS
- CORE → capital, services, infrastructure and decision power concentrate
- PERIPHERY → labour, raw materials and demand are organised around the core

TRIGGER / MECHANISM
- BACKWASH → talent and capital drain outward toward the core
- SPREAD → technology and demand may diffuse, but not automatically

EFFECT / INTERVENTION
- CORE → capital, services, infrastructure and decision power concentrate
- PERIPHERY → labour, raw materials and demand are organised around the core

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SPREAD → technology and demand may diffuse, but not automatically.

04

STAGE 04 PLANNING REGION CRITERIA

PLANNING REGION CRITERIA · FUNCTIONAL UNITY · FLOWS AND LINKAGES HOLD THE REGION TOGETHER · ADMINISTRATIVE MANAGEABILITY · POLICY MUST ACTUALLY BE IMPLEMENTABLE · ECONOMIC + ECOLOGICAL VIABILITY · STRATEGY AND RESOURCE BASE MUST ALIGN · SOCIAL ACCEPTABILITY

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS	TRIGGER / MECHANISM	EFFECT / INTERVENTION
FUNCTIONAL UNITY → flows and linkages hold the region together	ECONOMIC + ECOLOGICAL VIABILITY → strategy and resource base must align	FUNCTIONAL UNITY → flows and linkages hold the region together
ADMINISTRATIVE MANAGEABILITY → policy must actually be implementable	SOCIAL ACCEPTABILITY → regional identity and needs affect success	ADMINISTRATIVE MANAGEABILITY → policy must actually be implementable

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS
- FUNCTIONAL UNITY → flows and linkages hold the region together
- ADMINISTRATIVE MANAGEABILITY → policy must actually be implementable

TRIGGER / MECHANISM
- ECONOMIC + ECOLOGICAL VIABILITY → strategy and resource base must align
- SOCIAL ACCEPTABILITY → regional identity and needs affect success

EFFECT / INTERVENTION
- FUNCTIONAL UNITY → flows and linkages hold the region together
- ADMINISTRATIVE MANAGEABILITY → policy must actually be implementable

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SOCIAL ACCEPTABILITY → regional identity and needs affect success.

05

STAGE 05 INDIAN PLANNING TIMELINE

INDIAN PLANNING TIMELINE · NATIONAL PLANNING COMMITTEE BEGINS THE PLANNING IMAGINATION · PLANNING COMMISSION SET UP AND FIRST PLAN LAUNCHED · ANNUAL PLANS AFTER WAR, DROUGHT AND MACRO STRESS · TWELFTH PLAN LAST CYCLE; NITI REPLACES PLANNING COMMISSION

1938 → National Planning Committee begins the planning imagination → 1950-51 → Planning Commission set up and First Plan launched → 1966-69 → Annual Plans after war, drought and macro stress → 2012-17 / 2015 → Twelfth Plan last cycle; NITI replaces Planning Commission

SYSTEM / DEFINITION
- 1938 → National Planning Committee begins the planning imagination
- 1950-51 → Planning Commission set up and First Plan launched

PROCESS / MECHANISM
- 1966-69 → Annual Plans after war, drought and macro stress
- 2012-17 / 2015 → Twelfth Plan last cycle; NITI replaces Planning Commission

SPATIAL / INDIA PATTERN
- 1938 → National Planning Committee begins the planning imagination
- 1950-51 → Planning Commission set up and First Plan launched

HAZARD / LIMIT / RESPONSE
- 1966-69 → Annual Plans after war, drought and macro stress
- 2012-17 / 2015 → Twelfth Plan last cycle; NITI replaces Planning Commission

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 2012-17 / 2015 → Twelfth Plan last cycle; NITI replaces Planning Commission.

06

STAGE 06 FIRST VERSUS SECOND PLAN

FIRST VERSUS SECOND PLAN · FIRST PLAN · IRRIGATION, AGRICULTURE, REFUGEE RESETTLEMENT, POWER · SECOND PLAN · HEAVY INDUSTRY AND PUBLIC-SECTOR INDUSTRIAL BASE · SPATIAL LOGIC · AGRARIAN RECOVERY FIRST, INDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION NEXT · DO NOT SWAP THE PRIORITIES OF THE TWO PLANS

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS	TRIGGER / MECHANISM	EFFECT / INTERVENTION
FIRST PLAN → irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power	SPATIAL LOGIC → agrarian recovery first, industrial concentration next	FIRST PLAN → irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power
SECOND PLAN → heavy industry and public-sector industrial base	TRAP → do not swap the priorities of the two plans	SECOND PLAN → heavy industry and public-sector industrial base

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS
- FIRST PLAN → irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power
- SECOND PLAN → heavy industry and public-sector industrial base

TRIGGER / MECHANISM
- SPATIAL LOGIC → agrarian recovery first, industrial concentration next
- TRAP → do not swap the priorities of the two plans

EFFECT / INTERVENTION
- FIRST PLAN → irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power
- SECOND PLAN → heavy industry and public-sector industrial base

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → do not swap the priorities of the two plans.

07

STAGE 07 WHY IMBALANCE PERSISTED

WHY IMBALANCE PERSISTED · UNEVEN IRRIGATION · GREEN REVOLUTION GAINS STAYED REGIONALLY SELECTIVE · INDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION · PORTS, METROS AND CORRIDORS PULLED AHEAD · CONNECTIVITY + GOVERNANCE GAPS · INTERIORS REMAINED INFRASTRUCTURE-POOR · BALANCED REGIONAL DEVELOPMENT STAYED INCOMPLETE

UNEVEN IRRIGATION → Green Revolution gains stayed regionally selective → INDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION → ports, metros and corridors pulled ahead → CONNECTIVITY + GOVERNANCE GAPS → interiors remained infrastructure-poor → OUTCOME → balanced regional development stayed incomplete

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS
- UNEVEN IRRIGATION → Green Revolution gains stayed regionally selective
- INDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION → ports, metros and corridors pulled ahead

TRIGGER / MECHANISM
- CONNECTIVITY + GOVERNANCE GAPS → interiors remained infrastructure-poor
- OUTCOME → balanced regional development stayed incomplete

EFFECT / INTERVENTION
- UNEVEN IRRIGATION → Green Revolution gains stayed regionally selective
- INDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION → ports, metros and corridors pulled ahead

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONNECTIVITY + GOVERNANCE GAPS → interiors remained infrastructure-poor.

08

STAGE 08 PLANNING COMMISSION VERSUS NITI

PLANNING COMMISSION VERSUS NITI · PLANNING COMMISSION · CENTRALISED PLAN FORMULATION AND OUTLAY LOGIC · NITI AAYOG · THINK-TANK COORDINATION, COMPETITIVE AND COOPERATIVE FEDERALISM · PLAN DOCUMENTS · LONG-HORIZON ALLOCATION FRAMEWORK · INDICATOR MONITORING AND MISSION-MODE COMPARISON

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS	TRIGGER / MECHANISM	EFFECT / INTERVENTION
PLANNING COMMISSION → centralised plan formulation and outlay logic	PLAN DOCUMENTS → long-horizon allocation framework	PLANNING COMMISSION → centralised plan formulation and outlay logic
NITI AAYOG → think-tank coordination, competitive and cooperative federalism	DASHBOARDS → indicator monitoring and mission-mode comparison	NITI AAYOG → think-tank coordination, competitive and cooperative federalism

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS
- PLANNING COMMISSION → centralised plan formulation and outlay logic
- NITI AAYOG → think-tank coordination, competitive and cooperative federalism

TRIGGER / MECHANISM
- PLAN DOCUMENTS → long-horizon allocation framework
- DASHBOARDS → indicator monitoring and mission-mode comparison

EFFECT / INTERVENTION
- PLANNING COMMISSION → centralised plan formulation and outlay logic
- NITI AAYOG → think-tank coordination, competitive and cooperative federalism

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NITI AAYOG → think-tank coordination, competitive and cooperative federalism.

09

STAGE 09 DISTRICT AND BLOCK TARGETING LADDER

DISTRICT AND BLOCK TARGETING LADDER · STATE AVERAGE · USEFUL BUT HIDES INTERNAL INEQUALITY · DISTRICT TARGETING · ASPIRATIONAL DISTRICTS BRINGS LAGGING DISTRICTS INTO FOCUS · BLOCK TARGETING · SCALE MOVES FURTHER DOWNWARD WHERE DISTRICT AVERAGES STILL HIDE · GEOGRAPHIC LESSON

STATE AVERAGE → useful but hides internal inequality

DISTRICT TARGETING → Aspirational Districts brings lagging districts into focus → BLOCK TARGETING → scale moves further downward where district averages still hide gaps → GEOGRAPHIC LESSON → intra-state disparity is a first-order planning problem

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS
- STATE AVERAGE → useful but hides internal inequality
- DISTRICT TARGETING → Aspirational Districts brings lagging districts into focus

TRIGGER / MECHANISM
- BLOCK TARGETING → scale moves further downward where district averages still hide gaps
- GEOGRAPHIC LESSON → intra-state disparity is a first-order planning problem

EFFECT / INTERVENTION
- STATE AVERAGE → useful but hides internal inequality
- DISTRICT TARGETING → Aspirational Districts brings lagging districts into focus

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: GEOGRAPHIC LESSON → intra-state disparity is a first-order planning problem.

10

STAGE 10 SDG-STYLE BENCHMARKING

SDG-STYLE BENCHMARKING · SDG INDIA INDEX 2023-24 · OVERALL INDIA SCORE 71 · TERRITORIAL INDICATORS · DEVELOPMENT IS RANKED SPATIALLY, NOT ONLY NATIONALLY · CURRENT STYLE · DASHBOARDS COMPLEMENT MISSIONS AND PROGRAMME CONVERGENCE · SAFE USE

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS	TRIGGER / MECHANISM	EFFECT / INTERVENTION
SDG INDIA INDEX 2023-24 → overall India score 71	CURRENT STYLE → dashboards complement missions and programme convergence	SDG INDIA INDEX 2023-24 → overall India score 71
TERRITORIAL INDICATORS → development is ranked spatially, not only nationally	SAFE USE → planning changed form, but not the geography of disparity	TERRITORIAL INDICATORS → development is ranked spatially, not only nationally

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS
- SDG INDIA INDEX 2023-24 → overall India score 71
- TERRITORIAL INDICATORS → development is ranked spatially, not only nationally

TRIGGER / MECHANISM
- CURRENT STYLE → dashboards complement missions and programme convergence
- SAFE USE → planning changed form, but not the geography of disparity

EFFECT / INTERVENTION
- SDG INDIA INDEX 2023-24 → overall India score 71
- TERRITORIAL INDICATORS → development is ranked spatially, not only nationally

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SAFE USE → planning changed form, but not the geography of disparity.

11

STAGE 11 REGIONAL DEVELOPMENT ANSWER SPINE

REGIONAL DEVELOPMENT ANSWER SPINE · DISPARITY VERSUS DIVERSITY AND THE MEANING OF REGIONAL PLANNING · GROWTH POLE, CORE-PERIPHERY, SPREAD AND BACKWASH · 1938 COMMITTEE, FIRST PLAN, SECOND PLAN, NITI TRANSITION · DISTRICT DASHBOARDS MATTER BECAUSE STATE AVERAGES CONCEAL DISPARITY

DEFINE → disparity versus diversity and the meaning of regional planning → EXPLAIN → growth pole, core-periphery, spread and backwash → TRACE → 1938 committee, First Plan, Second Plan, NITI transition → QUALIFY → district dashboards matter because state averages conceal disparity

SYSTEM / DEFINITION
- DEFINE → disparity versus diversity and the meaning of regional planning
- EXPLAIN → growth pole, core-periphery, spread and backwash

PROCESS / MECHANISM
- TRACE → 1938 committee, First Plan, Second Plan, NITI transition
- QUALIFY → district dashboards matter because state averages conceal disparity

SPATIAL / INDIA PATTERN
- DEFINE → disparity versus diversity and the meaning of regional planning
- EXPLAIN → growth pole, core-periphery, spread and backwash

HAZARD / LIMIT / RESPONSE
- TRACE → 1938 committee, First Plan, Second Plan, NITI transition
- QUALIFY → district dashboards matter because state averages conceal disparity

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: QUALIFY → district dashboards matter because state averages conceal disparity.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · ONE INTERPRETATION SAYS INDIA HAS MOVED FROM CENTRALISED FIVE-YEAR · ANOTHER SAYS THE UNDERLYING ISSUE REMAINS THE SAME · HOW TO REDUCE · REGIONAL IMBALANCE IN LAGGING DISTRICTS, SMALL TOWNS, TRIBAL BELTS · A GOOD MAINS ANSWER SHOULD THEREFORE TREAT NITI AS · THE PLANNING COMMISSION WAS REPLACED BY NITI AAYOG ON · THE TWELFTH PLAN WAS THE LAST FIVE-YEAR PLAN CYCLE.

OPTIONAL PROCESS DEPTH
- CAUTION: One interpretation says India has moved from centralised Five-Year Plans to more flexible mission-based and state-compared governance.
- CAUTION: Another says the underlying issue remains the same: how to reduce
- regional imbalance in lagging districts, small towns, tribal belts and infrastructure-poor interiors.
- CAUTION: A good Mains answer should therefore treat NITI as a change in planning style, not the end of planning geography.

DATA / INSTITUTION LIMIT
- The Planning Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog on 1 January 2015.
- The Twelfth Plan was the last Five-Year Plan cycle.
- Balanced regional development remained an explicit concern but an incomplete achievement.
- Aspirational Districts Programme targets districts, not states as a whole.

CONTEMPORARY PARALLEL
- SDG India Index is a territorial-development benchmarking tool.
- NOT: NITI Aayog is simply the Planning Commission with a new name - The institutional style and policy mechanism changed significantly.
- NOT: Ending Five-Year Plans ended planning - Planning continues through missions, indices, state coordination and targeted programmes.
- NOT: Regional imbalance is only about poor states - It also exists within states, between districts and between metros and hinterlands.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels